

# Jiayin Masterclass

Brand, website and school-operations platform for an elite Melbourne ballet academy — the full architecture, the design direction, and the first steps of the build.

PREPARED FROM AN AUDIT OF JIAYINMASTERCLASS.DANCE    DRAFT FOR DISCUSSION

01 The brief

03 References worth studying

05 The platform

07 Roadmap & first steps

02 Brand direction

04 The website

06 Technology stack

08 Open questions for the school

## 01 The brief

Jiayin Masterclass is not a neighbourhood dance studio. It was founded by **Jiayin Du** — a former dancer with The Australian Ballet who then taught at The Australian Ballet School for seven years — and it trains students in the Vaganova method under RAD examination, on an annual-enrolment model that costs families close to **A\$15,000 a year**. The product is genuinely elite. The digital presence is not: a template site, no brand system, a bolt-on shopping cart, events ticketed through TryBooking, and a *gmail.com* contact address.

That gap is the whole project. At this price point, parents are not buying dance classes — they are buying a formation, a faculty, and an institution. Every pixel and every email has to feel like the institution.

### What exists today

- **Four program lines:** a Regular Curriculum (Pre-Primary at age 5 through Advanced 1 and Pre-Professional), the audition-only *Endeavor to Elite* program, a Vocational stream with a VET/VCE Dance pathway, and open masterclasses & holiday programs sold to external students (currently ~A\$330 per event via TryBooking).
- **A faculty of nine**, several with Vaganova and RAD credentials — a real asset, currently presented as a flat list.
- **Annual enrolment**, no trial classes, studio tours by appointment. Admission already behaves like an application process; the website presents it like e-commerce ("Enrol Now", cart with 0 items).
- **No operational backend.** Scheduling, invoicing, parent communication and event ticketing all live outside the site, presumably in spreadsheets, WeChat/email threads and TryBooking.

- **Housekeeping debt:** two live domains (jiayinmasterclass.com and .dance), a broken About link in the nav, copy that argues tuition "works out to about \$30 an hour," and austballet@gmail.com as the public contact.

## Three workstreams

Everything in this document hangs off three parallel efforts:

|                     |                                                                                                                                                                              |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>The Brand</b>    | A quiet-luxury identity system — palette, typography, photography, voice — defined once and applied everywhere: website, invoices, emails, studio signage. Section 02.       |
| <b>The Website</b>  | A rewritten, redesigned marketing site whose job is to justify the fee before a parent ever asks about it. Section 04.                                                       |
| <b>The Platform</b> | A school-operations backend: classes, terms, teacher schedules, enrolments, invoicing, reminders, events, custom forms — with a parent portal and admin console. Section 05. |

## 02 Brand direction

The positioning in one line: *quiet authority*. This should feel like the Aman hotel of ballet schools — not the loudest studio on the strip. The school's own language already points there ("an academy of refinement, discipline and purpose"); the visual identity just has to catch up to it.

Four pillars to design and write from, all of them true and specific to this school:

- **Lineage** — The Australian Ballet, The Australian Ballet School, the Vaganova tradition. Named institutions, not adjectives.
- **Rigour** — every student examined under RAD; a curriculum planned in years, not terms.
- **Formation** — annual enrolment as a feature, not a payment plan: one year treated as a single body of work.
- **Care** — the scientific, injury-prevention approach; exacting yet humane.

## Palette

Ivory with a rose cast — the colour of pointe-shoe satin and marley floor under warm light — grounded by a plum-black "stage noir." Gold appears only as hairlines and small type, the way it appears on a program cover. This document is set in the proposed palette, in both light and dark themes, so you are looking at the brand while reading about it.



### Blush Ivory

#F7F1EC

Ground. Pages, paper, email stock.

### Stage Noir

#1D1418

Dark ground: footers, heroes, evening pages.

### Graphite Plum

#281E24

Ink. All running text on ivory.

### Pointe Rose

#DFC2B6

Satin accent: surfaces, tags, hover states.

### Antique Gold

#8A6A3E

Hairlines & labels only. Brightens to #C6A26B on noir.

### Merlot

#5F2E3A

Links, emphasis, the single "action" colour.

Proportion: ~68% ivory · 20% noir · 8% rose · gold and merlot in the low single digits.

If a page looks colourful, it is off-brand.

#### PALETTE RULES

Gold is never a fill or a button background — hairlines, numerals and small caps only. Rose is never allowed to drift toward bubblegum; if in doubt, desaturate. Photography carries the emotion and colour; the interface stays almost monochrome around it. Semantic colours (success green, warning amber) exist only inside the platform UI and never appear on the marketing site.

## Typography

# Exacting yet inspiring, disciplined yet *deeply humane*.

Display: a high-contrast didone — hairline serifs, vertical stress, the typographic equivalent of a dancer's line. Body: a quiet humanist grotesque that disappears behind the content. Numerals set tabular in schedules and invoices.

DISPLAYED HERE — BODONI MODA & HANKEN GROTESK (OPEN LICENCES)

| ROLE           | FIRST CHOICE (LICENSED)                                    | NO-BUDGET STAND-IN (GOOGLE FONTS)      | USAGE                                                                                                                            |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Display serif  | Canela (Commercial Type) or Saol Display                   | Bodoni Moda — used in this document    | Headlines, pull-quotes, program names. Weight 400 and below; never bold.                                                         |
| Text grotesque | Neue Haas Grotesk or Söhne                                 | Hanken Grotesk — used in this document | Body copy, UI, forms, emails. 400/600 only.                                                                                      |
| Labels         | The grotesque at 10–12px, +0.2em letter-spacing, uppercase |                                        | Eyebrows, table headers, buttons.                                                                                                |
| Chinese        | Noto Serif SC (display) + Noto Sans SC (text)              |                                        | The audience is visibly bilingual (the school's social handle is 杜佳音芭蕾舞大师班). Chinese typography must be designed, not defaulted. |

## Art direction

- **One brand shoot before launch.** Half a day in the studio, natural light: barre details, rosin box, pointe shoes being sewn, chalk dust, the corridor before class. Then formal faculty portraits on a single neutral seamless so the nine teachers finally read as one institution.
- **Motion is allowed to blur.** A slightly blurred grand jeté says more about live training than a frozen, watermarked competition photo. No stock imagery, ever.
- **Negative space is the luxury signal.** One image per viewport where possible. If a section needs three photos, it is two sections.
- **Website motion:** slow fades (300–500ms), parallax drift of a few pixels at most, no bounce, no carousels that auto-advance. Respect *prefers-reduced-motion* throughout.

# Voice — and the copy rewrite

The rewrite rule is simple: **specificity is the luxury**. Generic praise ("high-quality ballet education") reads as cheap; named institutions, numbers and rituals read as expensive. Three examples against current copy:

AS WRITTEN TODAY

Annual tuition spread across the year's class hours works out to approximately \$30 for each hour.

REWRITTEN

One enrolment, one year of formation. Tuition is set annually and covers the complete curriculum — technique, pointe, character, conditioning and examination preparation — planned as a single body of work.

Luxury never argues price per hour; per-hour math invites comparison with the studio down the road. The annual fee is reframed as the structure of the education itself.

AS WRITTEN TODAY

Structured, high-quality ballet education combining the Vaganova method with RAD examinations.

REWRITTEN

Training in the Vaganova tradition, examined by the Royal Academy of Dance, led by faculty formed at The Australian Ballet.

AS WRITTEN TODAY

Ticket Selling Fast, Secure Yours Now.

REWRITTEN

The April masterclass is limited to twenty-four dancers. Applications close 28 March.

Scarcity stated as fact, with real numbers and dates — never urgency-speak. The same voice carries into transactional email: an invoice from this school should read like correspondence from a private school bursar, not a payment gateway.

## 03 References worth studying

Steal patterns, not pixels. Each of these is worth an evening with the inspector open:

| REFERENCE               | WHAT IT IS               | WHAT TO TAKE                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The Royal Ballet School | royalballetschool.org.uk | Institutional gravitas; how training pathways are presented as a progression map; alumni as proof.                         |
| The Australian Ballet   | australianballet.com.au  | The local gold standard and the founder's own lineage — photography treatment, restrained motion, dark-ground event pages. |
| Paris Opera Ballet      | operadeparis.fr          | Didone typography over noir; season/event listing design; how a schedule can feel like a program booklet.                  |
| Princess Grace Academy  | Monte-Carlo              | A boutique elite academy (small cohort, big institution energy) — the closest positioning match to Jiayin.                 |

|                   |                                    |                                                                                                                                |
|-------------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Aman Resorts      | aman.com                           | Non-dance, pure tone reference: pacing, whitespace, one-image-per-viewport, how silence justifies price.                       |
| Institut Le Rosey | rosey.ch                           | How elite schools frame extreme fees — outcomes, tradition and admission selectivity. Note there is no per-hour math anywhere. |
| Cal.com           | Open source<br>(github.com/calcom) | Scheduling UX and actual code patterns: availability, conflicts, timezone handling, ICS feeds.                                 |
| Linear            | linear.app                         | The quality bar for the admin console and portals — speed, keyboard-first, zero clutter.                                       |

#### ANTI-REFERENCES

Dance-school SaaS — Jackrabbit Class, DanceStudio-Pro, ClassManager — are worth a trial account each as *feature checklists* (they've spent a decade learning what studios need). They are never design references; their parent-facing UX is exactly what this brand must not feel like.

## 04 The website

The marketing site has one job: make the fee feel obvious. Structure follows the parent's decision journey — *who are you* → *what will my child become* → *how do we get in* — and the biggest single change is reframing "Enrol Now" e-commerce into an **Admissions** process, which matches how the school already operates (audition-based elite stream, no trials, tours by appointment).

### Sitemap

#### Home

One full-bleed image, one sentence of positioning, current masterclass, three doors: The Academy / Training / Admissions

#### The Academy

Our Story (founder lineage, told properly) · Faculty (portrait grid → individual profiles) · Artistic Patron · Policies & Child Safety

#### Training

The Curriculum (the pathway visualised, Pre-Primary → Pre-Professional) · Regular Curriculum · Endeavor to Elite (audition) · Vocational & VCE Dance · Masterclasses & Holiday Programs

#### Admissions

How admission works (staged: enquiry → tour → placement class → offer) · Fees (annual, framed as formation) · Book a Tour · FAQ

#### Calendar & Events

Public events, masterclasses, performances — each with its own bookable page (replaces TryBooking, \$05)

#### Journal

News, exam results, competition outcomes, alumni placements — the proof engine. *Optional at launch.*

#### Contact

admissions@jjayinmasterclass.com · studio address · tour booking form

#### Portal

Separate sign-in for enrolled families and staff — the platform of \$05, visually of the same brand but clearly a different room.

#### HOUSEKEEPING AT LAUNCH

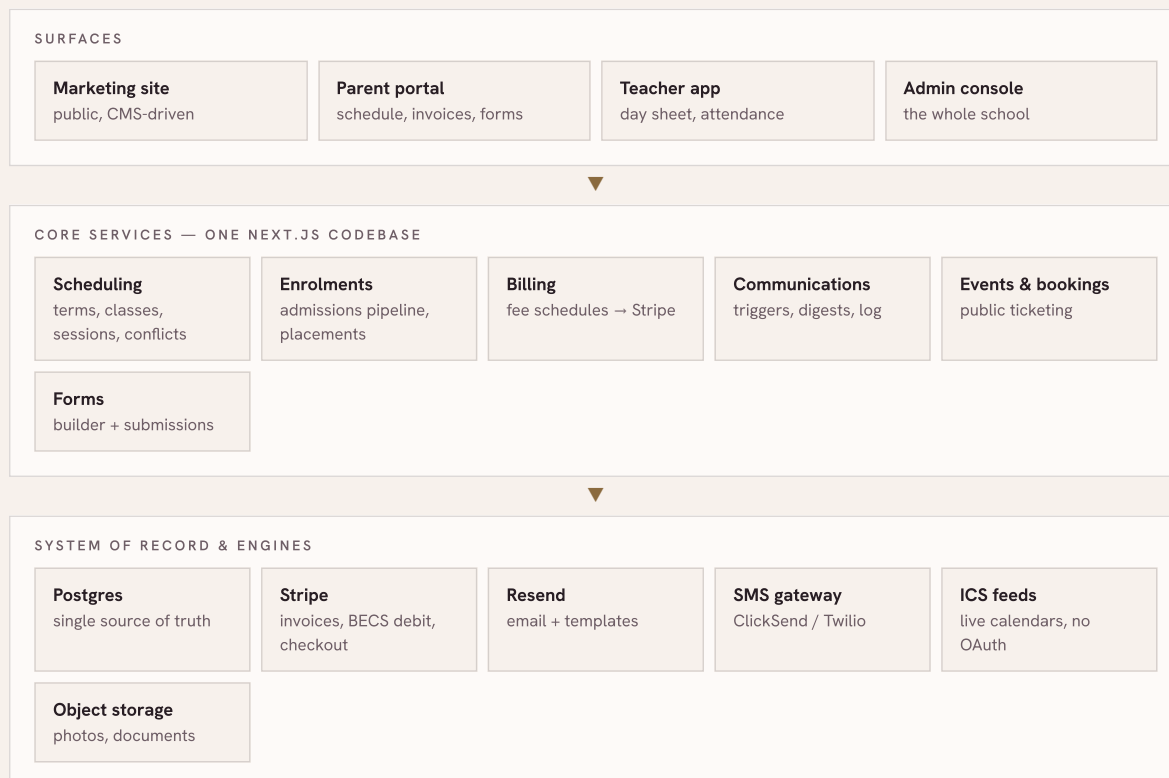
Consolidate to [jainmasterclass.com](https://jainmasterclass.com) with a 301 from .dance. Move email to Google Workspace on the domain (admissions@, accounts@, faculty@) and retire [austballet@gmail.com](mailto:austballet@gmail.com) from every public surface. Fix the dead About link as part of the content migration audit. Bilingual: launch English-first with translated Admissions and Fees pages (the two pages Chinese-speaking parents most need), full 中文 mirror in a later phase.

## 05 The platform

The operational heart of the rebuild. Three principles keep it sane:

- **One system of record.** Postgres holds every student, class, session and dollar. The portal, the emails and the reports are all views over the same tables.
- **Don't rebuild billing physics.** Stripe is the payments engine — invoices, instalment schedules, direct debit, receipts, dunning. The platform decides *what* to charge; Stripe handles *how*.
- **Everything sent is logged.** Every email and SMS lands in a notification log attached to the family. "Did you get our reminder?" is answerable in one click.

### Architecture



### Data model

Twenty-odd entities, in four families. This is the vocabulary every feature is built from:

| GROUP | ENTITIES | NOTES |
|-------|----------|-------|
|       |          |       |

|                            |                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>People &amp; access</b> | Family · Guardian · Student · StaffMember · User (role-scoped)                                         | The <i>Family</i> is the account: guardians share visibility of all their children, invoices and messages. Staff records carry Working-with-Children check numbers and expiry.                     |
| <b>Teaching</b>            | Program · Level · Term · Studio · ClassOffering · Session · Enrolment · Attendance · Waitlist          | A <i>ClassOffering</i> is the recurring slot (Grade 4 · Tue 4:30pm · Studio 1 · Ms Lazareva). A <i>Session</i> is one dated instance of it. Enrolment links a student to an offering for the year. |
| <b>Money</b>               | FeeSchedule · Invoice · InvoiceLine · Instalment · Payment · CreditNote                                | Fee schedules encode annual tuition per level plus extras (exams, costumes, events) and sibling discounts. Every money object mirrors a Stripe object ID.                                          |
| <b>Engagement</b>          | Event · TicketType · EventBooking · Form · FormSubmission · ConsentRecord · NotificationLog · AuditLog | EventBookings accept external customers (no Family required) — this is what replaces TryBooking. ConsentRecords gate whether a child's photo may appear anywhere.                                  |

## The scheduling engine

The piece that makes teacher schedules, parent calendars and reminders all fall out of one action:

1. **Admin defines a Term** (Victoria has four) with start, end and holiday dates.
2. **ClassOfferings carry a weekly recurrence**. Generating a term expands every offering into dated *Sessions*, skipping holidays.
3. **Conflict detection runs at write time**: a teacher or a studio can't be in two Sessions at once; the console refuses the double-booking before it exists.
4. **Exceptions edit Sessions, not Offerings**. Teacher ill on the 14th → that one Session is reassigned or cancelled, and only affected families are notified.
5. **Publishing produces calendars for free**: each family and each teacher gets a private ICS feed URL — subscribe once in Google/Apple Calendar and every future change flows through automatically. No OAuth, no sync jobs. (Two-way Google Calendar sync for teachers is a later nice-to-have.)

## Billing

- **Annual tuition, humane instalments**. The enrolment generates the year's fee from the FeeSchedule; families choose annual, per-term or monthly instalments — implemented as Stripe invoices on a schedule, paid by **BECS direct debit** (cheap, Australian, set-and-forget) or card.
- **Dunning with manners**. Reminder 7 days before due, on the day, +3 days. After that the system stops and flags for a personal call — at this fee level, a human contacts the family; a fourth robot email never does.
- **Event ticketing in-house**. Masterclasses and holiday programs sell through Stripe Checkout on the school's own event pages — the brand keeps the whole journey, the school keeps the customer data and most of the ticketing fee TryBooking currently takes.
- **Accountant-friendly**: nightly sync of invoices and payments to **Xero**, which nearly every Australian accountant expects.

## Communications — the notification matrix

Every automated message the system sends, in one table. Default cadence favours a **Sunday week-ahead digest** over per-lesson spam — regular classes repeat weekly, so per-session reminders are noise; exceptions and events are where SMS earns its keep.

| TRIGGER                            | AUDIENCE                                | CHANNEL     | TIMING                             |
|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-------------|------------------------------------|
| Offer & enrolment confirmed        | Guardians                               | Email       | On decision / on payment           |
| Portal invitation                  | Guardians                               | Email       | With enrolment confirmation        |
| Term schedule published            | All enrolled families                   | Email       | 2 weeks before term                |
| Week-ahead digest                  | Guardians (opt-out)                     | Email       | Sunday 5pm                         |
| Session change / cancellation      | Affected families only                  | SMS + email | Immediately on change              |
| Invoice issued                     | Guardians                               | Email       | Per instalment schedule            |
| Payment reminder                   | Guardians                               | Email       | -7d · due day · +3d, then human    |
| Receipt                            | Guardians                               | Email       | On payment                         |
| Event announced                    | Chosen segment (families / public list) | Email       | Manual send                        |
| Event booking confirmed + reminder | Ticket holder (incl. external)          | Email, SMS  | On purchase · 48h before           |
| Absence recorded                   | Guardians                               | Email       | Same evening                       |
| Form assigned / unanswered         | Guardians                               | Email       | On assignment · chase +5d          |
| Day sheet                          | Teachers                                | Email       | 7am daily (or weekly, per teacher) |

## Custom forms

A small form-builder (fields stored as a JSON schema, rendered in the portal) covers the school's entire paper trail: media & photography consent, medical details and allergies, costume measurements, audition applications for the Elite program, exam entry, tour bookings. Every submission is versioned, attached to the student, and chased automatically when ignored.

## The two portals

| PARENT PORTAL                                                                                                                                                       |  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| <p>This week's schedule per child · full term calendar + ICS subscribe · invoices &amp; payment method · absences (report one, see history) · forms to complete</p> |  |



#### COMPLIANCE — NON-NEGOTIABLES

Children's data under the Australian Privacy Act: collect the minimum, encrypt at rest, no photos published without a live ConsentRecord. Staff records carry Working-with-Children check status with expiry alerts. Card and bank details never touch the server — Stripe-hosted fields only. Full audit log on every admin mutation.

## 06 Technology stack

| LAYER              | CHOICE                                                                      | WHY                                                                                                                                |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Framework          | Next.js 15 (App Router), TypeScript                                         | One codebase for marketing site, portals and admin; server components suit a content-heavy luxury site; largest hiring pool later. |
| Hosting            | Vercel                                                                      | Zero-ops, preview deploys for client review, Sydney edge region.                                                                   |
| Database           | Postgres on Supabase (Sydney) + Drizzle ORM                                 | Managed Postgres with auth, row-level security for family-scoped portal access, file storage included.                             |
| Auth               | Supabase Auth                                                               | Email magic-links for parents (no passwords to forget), role claims for staff/admin.                                               |
| Payments           | Stripe (AU): Invoicing, subscription schedules, BECS direct debit, Checkout | Instalments, dunning, receipts and event ticketing without building billing infrastructure.                                        |
| Email              | Resend + React Email                                                        | Branded transactional templates in code — the invoice email uses the same didone and ivory as the site.                            |
| SMS                | ClickSend (AU rates) or Twilio                                              | Only for changes, cancellations and event-day reminders.                                                                           |
| CMS                | Sanity                                                                      | Marketing content (faculty bios, programs, events, journal) editable by the school without touching the platform.                  |
| Accounting         | Xero sync                                                                   | Invoices and payments flow to the school's accountant automatically.                                                               |
| Analytics / errors | Plausible · Sentry                                                          | Cookie-banner-free analytics befitting the brand; error visibility from day one.                                                   |

### Build vs. buy — the honest version

**Buying** (Jackrabbit Class, DanceStudio-Pro, ClassManager) gets scheduling and billing running in a fortnight for ~A\$100-200/month. The cost is the brand: parents at a \$15k school would live inside a generic 2012-era portal, the marketing site and the operations system would never share data, and custom forms, bilingual comms and an admissions pipeline don't fit. **Building** costs months but makes the portal itself part of the luxury product — and with Stripe, Supabase and Resend doing the heavy lifting, the genuinely custom surface is smaller than it looks: scheduling logic, enrolment flow, and the UI.

**Recommendation:** build, in the phase order below — and if day-to-day admin is drowning *right now*, run one bought tool purely as an internal stopgap, never parent-facing, until Phase 2 replaces it.

## 07 Roadmap & first steps

Sequenced so something visible ships every few weeks and revenue-touching work lands early. Durations assume one to two people building; treat them as elapsed-time estimates, not promises.

### 0

WEEKS 1-2

#### Discovery & foundations

Answer \$08 with the school. Content and photography audit of both existing domains. Consolidate to jiyinmasterclass.com, set up Google Workspace, open the Stripe account and start BECS verification (it takes days — start now). Sign off the brand direction in \$02.

### 1

WEEKS 3-8

#### Brand & marketing site

Design system built from \$02; brand photo shoot; every page of \$04 rewritten and rebuilt on Next.js + Sanity. **Quick win inside this phase:** event pages with Stripe Checkout go live first, so the next masterclass sells on-brand instead of through TryBooking — the platform's first revenue before the platform exists.

### 2

WEEKS 8-16

#### Platform core

Data model, admin console, scheduling engine (terms → sessions → conflicts), enrolments, fee schedules and Stripe invoicing with instalments. Migrate current students and the year's schedule. The school runs on it internally before parents ever see it.

### 3

WEEKS 16-20

#### Portals & communications

Parent portal and teacher app, ICS calendar feeds, attendance, and the full notification matrix — digests, change alerts, dunning, day sheets. This is the phase parents feel.

### 4

WEEKS 20-24

#### Forms, refinement, 中文

Form builder and consent workflows, waitlists, reports (enrolment, revenue, attendance), Xero sync, Chinese-language portal and comms, and whatever Phase 3 taught us to fix.

## Start this week

#### 01

Book the discovery session with Jiayin and Angelbaby; walk in with \$08 printed.

#### 02

Register/confirm control of jiyinmasterclass.com, plan the 301 from .dance.

#### 03

Set up Google Workspace — admissions@, accounts@ — and schedule the retirement of the gmail address.

#### 04

Open Stripe, begin BECS direct-debit verification, connect a test Xero org.

#### 05

Create a trial account on Jackrabbit or DanceStudio-Pro and extract a feature checklist (one evening, then cancel).

06 Present \$02 for sign-off; lock palette and typefaces before any page is designed.

07 Brief the photographer against the \$02 shot list; hold the date before term events crowd it out.

08 Scaffold the repo: Next.js + Supabase + Stripe test mode deployed to Vercel — an empty but living system.

---

## 08 Open questions for the school

Every one of these changes a design decision above. Get them answered in the discovery session:

---

01 **How many enrolled students and families today?**

Sets scale for everything — and whether migration is an afternoon or a project.

---

02 **How many studios/locations, and are they owned or hired?**

Studio is a first-class scheduling entity; hired venues add availability constraints.

---

03 **Where does the school run today — spreadsheets, WeChat, anything else?**

Defines the migration source and the habits the platform must beat.

---

04 **The real fee schedule:**

tuition per level, exam/costume/event extras, sibling discounts, current payment methods and instalment habits.

---

05 **How do families pay now, and what are the arrears like?**

Shapes how firm the dunning sequence should be and whether direct debit is mandated at enrolment.

---

06 **Refund, make-up class and missed-lesson policy?**

Must be encoded in billing and stated on the Fees page.

---

07 **What share of families prefers Chinese-language communication?**

Decides whether 中文 comms move from Phase 4 into Phase 3.

---

08 **Who administers day-to-day, and how many hours a week?**

The admin console's real user — design for them, not for the founders.

---

09 **Teachers: employees or contractors, and do they need pay/hour reports?**

May add a payroll-report requirement to Phase 4.

---

10 **Photo/media consent status today?**

Existing signed forms can seed ConsentRecords; if none exist, the first form-builder job is obvious.

---

11 **What does the accountant use?**

Presumed Xero; confirm before building the sync.

---

12 **Is the Auckland masterclass a one-off or is interstate/international expansion planned?**

Multi-venue, multi-currency events change the ticketing model — better to know now.

